

NIGERIA YOUTH ENTREPRENEURSHIP INVESTMENT FUND

N-YIF

Discovery

Session

Brand Strategy · Identity · Digital Platform

Session Details

Facilitated by TM Global — TM Labs & Design Teem

Anchored by DBN · NSIA · AfDB

Classification: Confidential

PARTICIPANT NAME

ORGANISATION

DATE

N-YIF DISCOVERY

Brand Strategy & Identity Session — The Business

Stakeholder: _____

Organisation: _____

Section 1: The Business — These questions help us understand what N-YIF actually does, who it was built for, and what makes it structurally different from every other fund in the Nigerian ecosystem.

BUSINESS · ORIGIN

What is N-YIF?

Goal: Understand the founding problem

What frustrations, signals, or market gaps led to the creation of this initiative?

Think about the moment someone said "this needs to exist." What were they seeing?

BUSINESS · TIMING

Why N-YIF, why now?

Goal: Establish credibility signal

What track record or institutional capacity qualifies N-YIF to solve this problem at this scale?

What proof do DBN, NSIA, and AfDB bring that no prior Nigerian youth fund has had?

BUSINESS · OFFERING

What are we offering the market?

Goal: Map the full product suite

List every core product, instrument, or support N-YIF offers. Be exhaustive.

Include equity, quasi-equity, grants, guarantees, capacity building, ecosystem programs — everything.

BUSINESS · ACCESS

How do beneficiaries and investors access us?

Goal: Understand both journeys

BENEFICIARY JOURNEY

INVESTOR JOURNEY

N-YIF DISCOVERY

Brand Strategy & Identity Session — The Business (continued)

Stakeholder: _____

BUSINESS · AUDIENCE

Who are we doing this for?

Goal: Build the audience map

Define N-YIF's primary and secondary audiences as people — not categories.

Give each audience a name, a life situation, a frustration, and what success looks like for them.

 PERSONA 1 	 PERSONA 2 	 PERSONA 3
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BUSINESS · COMPETITION

Who are our key competitors?

Goal: Landscape awareness

Who else is serving our target audience? What are they doing well — and what are they missing?

DOING WELL 	MISSING / FAILING AT
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BUSINESS · DIFFERENTIATOR

What do we offer that no one else offers?

Goal: Uncover the unfair advantage

This could be a product, an experience, a capacity, or a structural feature uncommon in the market.

BUSINESS · PRIORITIES

Who gets funding priority?

Goal: Understand eligibility hierarchy

Are there specific project types, sectors, or entrepreneur profiles that receive priority from the fund?

- ☐ Climate-resilient / green businesses
- ☐ Women-led enterprises
- ☐ Tech-enabled MSMEs
- ☐ Export-ready businesses
- ☐ Other: _____

N-YIF DISCOVERY

Brand Strategy & Identity Session — Brand Positioning

Stakeholder: _____

Section 2: The Brand — Positioning — These exercises map where N-YIF sits in the market today and where it intends to sit. The positioning map gives us the strategic coordinates. The written section gives us the language.

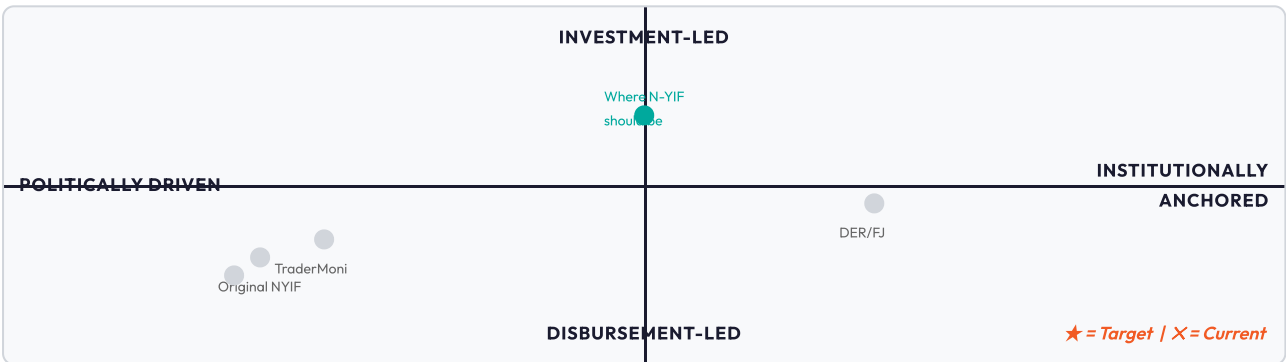
BRAND · MARKET POSITION

Where do we currently sit — and where do we want to sit?

Goal: Strategic coordinates

Mark a **X** for where N-YIF sits today, and a **★** for where you want to be.

The vertical axis measures Capital Nature (Disbursement vs. Investment). The horizontal axis measures Institutional Credibility (Political vs. Independent DFI-backed).



In your own words: what is the single most important thing that separates N-YIF from every Nigerian youth fund that came before it?

BRAND · POSITIONING STATEMENT

Brand Positioning — Write it out

Goal: Articulate the positioning in one statement

Complete the positioning framework below in your own words.

There are no wrong answers — we're listening for what you believe to be true, not what sounds official.

FOR WHOM (OUR AUDIENCE) _____

WHO NEED / STRUGGLE WITH (THE PROBLEM) _____

N-YIF IS (WHAT WE ARE / WHAT WE DO)

THAT (THE UNIQUE BENEFIT WE DELIVER)

UNLIKE (THE ALTERNATIVE / COMPETITION)

N-YIF DISCOVERY

Brand Strategy & Identity Session — The Brand

Stakeholder: _____

BRAND · PURPOSE

Why do we do this, beyond the mandate?

Goal: Uncover conviction

What does N-YIF contribute that genuinely matters — beyond capital deployed?

BRAND · IDENTITY

What is our ONE thing?

Goal: The singular brand idea

If N-YIF could be known for only one thing, what would it be? In which circles would we be known for it?

THE ONE THING

THE CIRCLES WHERE WE'RE KNOWN FOR IT

BRAND · VALUES

What values do we live by?

Goal: Operating values, not aspirational ones

List 3–4 values already true of how N-YIF operates. Aspirational values make weak foundations.

VALUE 1

VALUE 2

VALUE 3

VALUE 4

BRAND · NON-NEGOTIABLES

What are our non-negotiables?

Goal: The brand's lines in the sand

What would N-YIF always do — and what would it never do? Be specific.

WE WOULD ALWAYS

WE WOULD NEVER

BRAND · PERSONALITY

If N-YIF was a person...

Goal: Set the brand character

Circle 3 words that best describe N-YIF's personality:

Determined

Bold

Commanding

Visionary

Authoritative

Transformative

Approachable

Courageous

Knowledgeable

Analytical

Resilient

Disruptive

Thoughtful

Charismatic

Organized

Circle 3 words that best describe N-YIF's tone of voice:

Wise

Confident

Responsible

Powerful

Honest

Persuasive

Fearless

Structured

Informed

Defiant

Provocative

Genuine

Unconventional

Reflective

N-YIF DISCOVERY

Brand Strategy & Identity Session — Brand Story

Stakeholder: _____

The Brand Story Framework — Every powerful institution has a story that isn't just its history — it's its argument. Use the four-part framework below: the *Challenge* that existed before N-YIF, the *Change* it brings, the *Proof* of capacity, and the *Call to Action* it makes on the market.

BRAND · STORY

How would you tell our story?

Goal: The four-part brand narrative

Imagine you had 60 seconds to sell N-YIF to a new international investor. Walk through the four parts below.

01 THE CHALLENGE

What was the problem in Nigeria's youth investment landscape before this fund existed?

02 THE CHANGE

What does N-YIF change about how capital reaches young Nigerian founders?

03 THE PROOF

What specific facts, anchors, or institutional credentials prove we can deliver this change?

04 THE CALL

What do we ask from our audience — founders, investors, partners? What's the one thing we want them to do?

What are we promising people?

Goal: The brand's core commitment

What do we guarantee to our beneficiaries — and separately, to our investors? Why should they believe us?

TO FOUNDERS / BENEFICIARIES

TO INVESTORS / PARTNERS

N-YIF DISCOVERY

Brand Strategy & Identity Session — Vision & Impact

Stakeholder: _____

Section: Vision & Aspirational Neighbours — These questions help us understand what success looks and sounds like, and which brands in the world N-YIF wants to be measured against.

BRAND · ASPIRATION

Who are our aspirational neighbours?

Goal: Benchmark the brand ambition

Name at least 3 brands — inside or outside finance — that you admire. What specifically do you like about each?

BRAND 1 + WHAT WE LIKE

BRAND 2 + WHAT WE LIKE

BRAND 3 + WHAT WE LIKE

BRAND 4 (OPTIONAL)

BRAND · IMPACT HEADLINE

Imagine it's 2028. A major publication writes about N-YIF.

Goal: Future-state visioning

Write the headline and opening paragraph. What impact has been achieved in the next 12–24 months to get there?

Think BusinessDay, Bloomberg Africa, The Economist, or TechCabal. Write what you'd want to read.

PUBLICATION:

| DATE: 2028

BRAND · MILESTONES

What wins in the next 12 months signal we're on track?

Goal: Near-term brand proof points

List 3–5 specific things — deals closed, partners onboarded, founders funded, media coverage — that would signal the brand is working.

BRAND · LEGACY

If N-YIF became a global case study, what would we be known for?

Goal: Legacy framing

What 3–5 things would researchers, academics, and investors cite when studying our success?

N-YIF DISCOVERY

Brand Strategy & Identity Session — Visual Identity

Stakeholder: _____

Section: Visual Identity — The questions below help our design team understand the aesthetic direction before any mark is drawn. There are no wrong answers.

BRAND · LOGO DIRECTION

What resonates more for our logo?

Goal: Set the mark direction

Circle your preference:

- ☐ **Logo mark** — A symbol that stands alone (Apple, Twitter, WWF)
- ☐ **Word mark** — The name as the identity (Google, FedEx, L'Oréal)
- ☐ **Combination mark** — Symbol + name together (Adidas, Pepsi, Instagram)
- ☐ **Designer's discretion** — We trust the team's recommendation

BRAND · NAME TREATMENT

How do we want our name written in our logo?

Goal: Naming decision

We currently use "N-YIF" as the working acronym. This session is partly to confirm or reconsider that. Circle your preference:

- ☐ **N-YIF** — Keep the current working acronym
- ☐ **NYIF** — Drop the hyphen
- ☐ **YEIB / N-YEIB** — Use the AfDB house acronym
- ☐ **A new name entirely** — Something with more resonance

If a new name: what feeling or idea should it evoke?

BRAND · AUDIENCE BELIEF

What do we believe about our audience?

Goal: Founding insight that shapes communication

What market observation or insight shapes how N-YIF views every founder, investor, or partner it engages?

Example: "We believe every young Nigerian founder is an investable asset — the system just hasn't caught up yet."

Which adjective best describes our culture?

Goal: Internal brand character

Circle 3 words that reflect what N-YIF hires for and operates by:

Excellence

Innovation

Discipline

Achievement

Inclusivity

Leadership

Learning

Nonconformity

Teamwork

Responsibility

Truthful

Freedom

Disruption

Order

Empowerment

Anything else?

Goal: Capture what the questions didn't ask

Is there anything about N-YIF's identity, ambition, or market position that hasn't come up yet — and that you feel is essential for us to know?

Section 3: The Website — These questions define the digital experience: the visual tone, the user journeys, the functionality priorities, and the governance visibility for N-YIF's online platform.

WEBSITE · STRATEGIC POSITIONING & VIBE

Section A: Strategic Positioning & "Vibe"

Goal: Institutional digital branding requirements

1. On a scale of 1–5, how would you rank the desired "Brand Balance" for the landing page?



2. Which aesthetic approach best aligns with N-YIF's Strategic Positioning?

- ☐ **Cinematic:** High-quality motion, bold imagery, immersive storytelling.
- ☐ **Minimalist:** Clean, professional, data-focused for easy reading.
- ☐ **Traditional:** Classic institutional layout with heavy text and reports.

3. What is the #1 sentiment we want a global investor to feel when the page loads?

- ☐ Security & Transparency
- ☐ Innovation & Speed
- ☐ National Pride & Scale
- ☐ Inclusivity & Opportunity

WEBSITE · USER EXPERIENCE

Section B: User Experience & Inclusivity

Goal: Gender-inclusive and digitally enabled MSMEs

4. How should the website prioritize the "Gender-Inclusive" mandate visually?

- ☐ Dedicated sections for female founder success stories.
- ☐ Inclusive imagery integrated throughout the entire platform.
- ☐ A specific portal/landing page for women-led MSME resources.

5. Which "User Journey" is the highest priority for the 4–6 week launch?

- ☐ **The Investor:** Governance, board, and anchor investor info.
- ☐ **The Entrepreneur:** Funding types (Equity, Debt, Grant).
- ☐ **The Partner:** Newsletter updates and regional trade opportunities.

Section C: Functionality & Scale

Goal: CMS, Newsletters, and SEO

6. Which feature is most critical for stakeholder engagement on Day 1?

- ☐ Newsletter subscription and automated updates.
- ☐ News and Press Release room for institutional announcements.
- ☐ Interactive Impact Dashboard showing fund deployment.

7. Rate the importance of "Ease of Content Management" for your internal team:



N-YIF DISCOVERY

Website Strategy & Digital Branding Session — The Website (continued)

Stakeholder: _____

WEBSITE · GOVERNANCE

Section D: Governance & Trust

Goal: Addressing the mandate for transparency

8. How prominent should the "Governance Framework" be in the site architecture?

- ☐ Primary Menu item (Always visible)
- ☐ Sub-menu under "About the Fund"
- ☐ Footer Resource only

9. Which trust indicators are most vital to show "Above the Fold"?

- ☐ NSIA & Institutional Logos
- ☐ Real-time Fund Deployment Stats
- ☐ Testimonials from existing beneficiaries

WEBSITE · VISUAL DNA

Section E: Interactive Mood Board

Goal: Defining the visual DNA

10. Circle the 3 words that BEST describe the future N-YIF digital home:

Empowering

Transparent

Fast

Bold

Professional

Collaborative

Modern

Institutional

Accessible

Impactful

WEBSITE · OPEN STRATEGY

Section F: Open Strategy

Goal: Capture undocumented requirements

11. What is the one thing this website MUST do to be considered a success in 6 months?

12. Are there any specific "female-centric" features or resources you feel are missing from the current scope?

Section G: Call to Action

Goal: Driving conversion

13. What is the primary Call to Action for the landing page?

- ☐ "Subscribe for Updates"
- ☐ "Read the Governance Framework"
- ☐ "Learn About Our Investment Focus"

SESSION · CLOSE

Final reflection

Goal: Capture anything we missed

Is there anything about N-YIF — its story, ambition, constraints, or market context — that this workbook didn't make space for, and that our team needs to know before we begin?
